Cowabunga

SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

WED OCT 21, 2026

DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · WED OCT 21 · NORTH PB

The S swell is holding at 15 seconds with light morning wind. Little Point once the high drains, and out before the storms.

steady S groundswell, light wind: paddle out by 9

PADDLE OUT BY	9:00	BOARD Inferno 72 ~73°F WATER

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

Little Point

WINDOW	9–11:30a · Inferno 72 · ~73°F
SURF	3–5 ft (SRF), S 15s + W side swell
TIDE	L 0.6 @ 12:41a H 4.4 @ 7:17a L 2.0 @ 12:58p H 4.5 @ 6:42p obs 5.6 @ 5:48a

A tide gauge reading above the table is the ocean standing taller.

7 /10

SURF RATING · GOOD · LIVE

Good — worth rearranging your morning

capped by swell 3.3 ft · Better than 29% of 38 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

3–5 FT (SRF), S 15S + W SIDE SWELL

GROUND

SwH 3.0–3.6 ft · 14–15s

WINDSWELL

WWH 2.0 ft · 10s

HS BUOY

Hs 3.6 ft · 46258



FROM

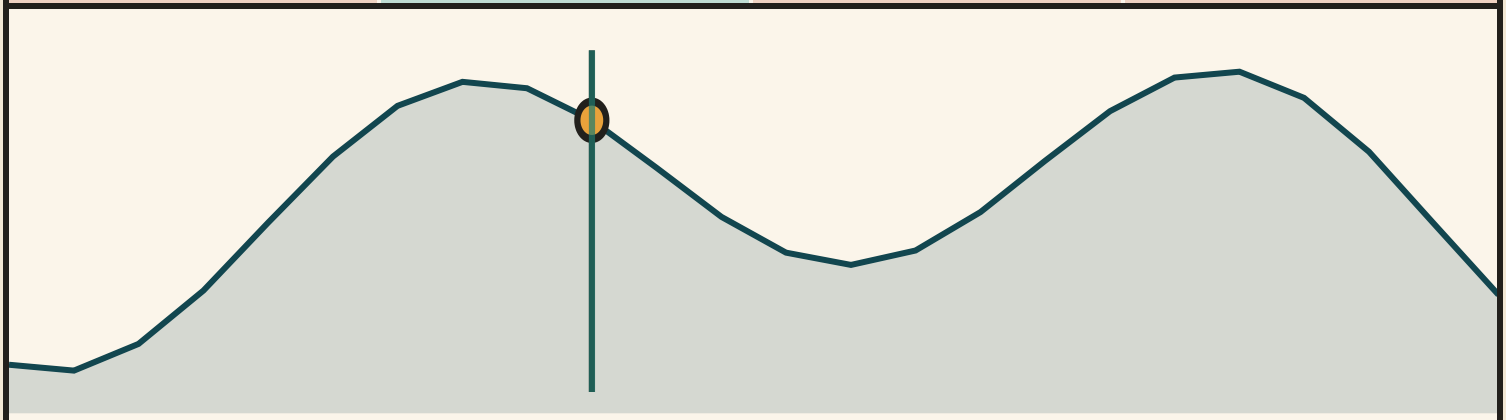
205° SSW

Buoy 46258 · Hs 3.6 ft @ 15s SSW (spectrum SwH 3.0–3.6 ft @ 14–15s overnight, steady) + WWH 2.0 ft @ 10s · face 3–5 ft (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 S 3 ft @ 14s + W 2 ft @ 14s · MWD 205° SSW · wind light E to 8a, S 10 mph from 11a

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

7–9A · REEF TOO FULL, DRIVE OK	9–11:30A · LITTLE POINT	11:30A–NOON · S 10 MPH	AFTERNOON · S WIND, STORMS 5P+
WAIT	**GO**	**MEH**	**SKIP**



9:00a	GO · Little Point	3.9 ft tide	SE ~4 kt · NWS	3–5 ft (SRF), S 15s + W side swell

L 0.6 @ 12:41a · H 4.4 @ 7:17a · L 2.0 @ 12:58p · H 4.5 @ 6:42p · obs 5.6 @ 5:48a

Little Point, 9 to about 11:30a, on the Inferno 72. Table tides: H 4.4 @ 7:17a, L 2.0 @ 12:58p, H 4.5 @ 6:42p. The gauge read 5.60 ft at 5:48a against about 4.0 predicted, so it is running about 1.6 ft over the table for the third day. That puts the reef near 6.0 ft at 8a, over the 5.5 ft ceiling, then about 5.5 ft at 9a, 4.9 ft at 10a and 4.2 ft at 11a. LJAC1 was light NNE 2 to 4 kt overnight, calm at 5a and S 3 kt at 5:06a. NWS hourly has E 5 mph from 6 to 8a, SE 5 mph at 9a, S 5 mph at 10a, then S 10 mph from 11a; PZZ740 has SE 10 kt becoming S this afternoon. Sunny morning, a slight chance of showers from 11a, and showers and thunderstorms from about 5p (NWS hourly 76%).

Where it's working

Little Point

Top of the scorecard at 0.97. The S groundswell is holding steady, not fading (46258 SwH 0.9–1.1 m, 3.0–3.6 ft, @ 14–15s since 12:56a, 3.3 ft @ 15s SSW at 5:26a, MWD 205°). The gauge is running about 1.6 ft over the table (5.60 ft at 5:48a vs about 4.0 predicted), so the reef sits near 6.0 ft around the 7:17a high, over its 5.5 ft ceiling, then drains to about 5.5 ft at 9a, 4.9 ft at 10a and 4.2 ft at 11a, never near the 3.0 ft floor before the 12:58p low (about 3.6 ft). NWS has E 5 mph to 8a, SE at 9a, S 5 mph at 10a and S 10 mph from 11a. Paddle out by 9:00.

CALL

- **Also fine · PB Drive at dawn**
  Score 0.94. The sandbar is fine on the full tide with light E wind from first light to about 9a, while the reef is still too deep. Fifteen-second sets can close out, so take the Anvil and then slide over to Little Point.

  ALSO

3. **Calumet**
   Score 0.77. Good swell angle, but flagged tide-high vs its window with the gauge this full. Pass.

   SOFT

4. **PB north of the pier**
   Score 0.72. Clean tide and wind, but the SSW angle mostly misses the pier wedge, and the W 2 ft @ 14s in PZZ740 is small.

   SOFT

- Skip · Tourmaline (0.60) and PB Point (0.51) are too full on the high gauge, and Tourmo gets high-tide mush. The Cliffs (Garbage, Abs, Luscomb's) and OB want a bigger W swell and lower tide; the W side swell today is only 2 ft. Blacks and Scripps (extended only) will show bigger sets on the S swell, but the walk and the S breeze from 11a do not beat a clean local reef.

  SKIP

BOARD

Inferno 72

~73°F

QUIVER

Sharp Eye Inferno 72

Chest-high-plus 15-second sets on a steep reef with light wind. Sunday showed the Anvil is too flat for these faces.

Anvil twin · for a dawn session on the Drive sandbar

TW log · too much push for it today

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

A tide gauge reading above the table is the ocean standing taller.

Tide tables only know the moon and sun. Warm water expands, and low pressure lets the sea bulge up, so this week the La Jolla gauge is reading about a foot and a half above the prediction. On a reef with a tide ceiling, that pushes the good window later on a morning high, so trust the gauge over the table.

SKIP

Little Point before 9a, when the gauge-adjusted high sits over the 5.5 ft ceiling. The afternoon, with S 10 mph from 11a and storms from about 5p. Calumet, Tourmo, and PB Point on a gauge this full. The Cliffs and OB on a small W side swell.

GOTCHAS

Lightning is the big one: NWS has showers and thunderstorms from about 5p and through tonight, so get out of the water at the first thunder. Rain later today starts the roughly 72-hour water-quality window for Thursday through Saturday. High rip current risk today (NWS SRF). Fifteen-second sets come in groups with long lulls, so watch a full set cycle before you paddle out.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL: Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES